“I should pray to angels for help.”

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Where it often comes from

Popular books, gift items, and media that encourage “calling on your angels.” Feeling that God is too big or distant to bother, while angels seem closer and more approachable. New Age spirituality mixed with Christian language. A sincere desire for protection and comfort. Not knowing what the Bible teaches about angels.

What Scripture teaches

Angels are real, and God sends them to serve and guard His people. But Scripture never directs us to pray to them. When John fell down before an angel, the angel stopped him: “Worship God!” Paul warned against the worship of angels. Jesus taught us to pray to “our Father in heaven.” You can bring every need directly to God, and He is able to command His angels as He sees fit.

> *“And I am John, who heard and saw these things. And when I had heard and seen them, I fell down to worship at the feet of the angel who had shown me these things. But he said to me, ‘Do not do that! I am a fellow servant with you and your brothers the prophets, and with those who keep the words of this book. Worship God!’”* **(Revelation 22:8–9)**.

Also see

> “So then, this is how you should pray: ‘Our Father in heaven, hallowed be Your name” **(Matthew 6:9)**.

> “Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus” **(Philippians 4:6–7)**.

> “Are not the angels ministering spirits sent to serve those who will inherit salvation?” **(Hebrews 1:14)**.

> “For He will command His angels concerning you to guard you in all your ways” **(Psalm 91:11)**.

Common self-statements

- My angels will protect me if I ask them.
- God is too busy, so I’ll ask an angel.
- Angels are easier to talk to than God.
- I need to call on the right angel for this problem.
- Praying to angels is just extra help.
- God won’t mind if I go to them instead.

Common logical errors

- **Accepting an idea without checking:** Adopting popular beliefs about angels without testing them by Scripture.
- **Projection:** Picturing God as too distant or busy to hear you directly.
- **Emotional reasoning:** Deciding a practice is right because it feels comforting.
- **Mixing truths:** Blending true facts about angels with practices Scripture warns against.

Challenging questions

- What did the angel say when John fell down before him?
- Who did Jesus teach us to pray to?
- Where in the Bible does anyone pray to an angel?
- Why would I go to a servant when I can go to the King, who is my Father?
- Who commands the angels?
- Is God really too busy for my prayers?
- Where did I learn to pray to angels: Scripture or popular culture?

Truth summary

> I do not need to pray to angels. I can pray directly to my Father in heaven, who hears me and cares for me. Angels are real, and God sends them to serve His people, but they point me to worship God, not themselves. I can thank God for His angels and bring every request to Him.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Prayer, How to
- Protection
- Worship
- God, First/Only
- Occult

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Prayer
- Christ, Who He Is

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I should pray to angels for help"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I should pray to angels for help." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did the angel tell John to do?
- ☐ Who did Jesus teach me to pray to?
- ☐ Does anyone in the Bible pray to angels?
- ☐ Why go to a servant when I can go to my Father?
- ☐ Who commands the angels?
- ☐ Did I learn this from Scripture or from culture?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I can pray directly to my Father in heaven.
- ☐ God hears me and is never too busy for me.
- ☐ Angels serve God and point me to worship Him.
- ☐ God commands His angels to guard me as He wills.
- ☐ I bring every request to God with thanksgiving.
- ☐ Worship belongs to God alone.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Revelation 22:8–9**
  "And I am John, who heard and saw these things. And when I had heard and seen them, I fell down to worship at the feet of the angel who had shown me these things. But he said to me, 'Do not do that! I am a fellow servant with you and your brothers the prophets, and with those who keep the words of this book. Worship God!'"
- [ ] **Matthew 6:9**
  "So then, this is how you should pray: 'Our Father in heaven, hallowed be Your name."
- [ ] **Philippians 4:6–7**
  "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus."
- [ ] **Hebrews 1:14**
  "Are not the angels ministering spirits sent to serve those who will inherit salvation?"
- [ ] **Psalm 91:11**
  "For He will command His angels concerning you to guard you in all your ways."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Prayer log:** Each day, write one request I brought directly to God and anything I noticed afterward.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Psalm 91:11 becomes: "For He will command His angels concerning **Sarah** to guard **her** in all **her** ways."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Prayer, How to" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Each time you are tempted to call on an angel,** pray instead, "Father, You know what I need," and name it.
- ☐ **Remove one item, book, or app** that encourages praying to angels, and replace it with a Scripture card.
- ☐ **Read every passage about angels in Hebrews 1** and write down what angels are for.
- ☐ **Pray the Lord's Prayer slowly each morning this week,** noticing who it is addressed to.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I should pray to angels for help": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One request I brought to God
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I should pray to angels for help.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Our Father in heaven, thank You that I can come to You directly. Help me reject the idea that I should pray to angels. Thank You for the angels You send to serve Your people, and help me give all my worship and trust to You alone. You hear me, and You care for me. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.